

VENUGOPAL DHOOT

54, INDUSTRIALIST (33)

EYEING EVERY PIE

BECAUSE the turnover of his group, Videocon, has shot up from Rs 14,000 crore to Rs 18,000 crore within a year. Because his group market capitalisation has touched Rs 20,000 crore. Because Videocon controls 30 per cent of the consumer goods market. Because he is now entering the telecom sector, having bagged a licence for 22 circles. Because he has expanded his investments in oilfields with over 13 blocks including 10 in Brazil. Because he is unrolling an ambitious power project with a capacity of over 10,000 MW. Because he has expanded his retail presence with a plan for 1,000 stores by 2009. Because no matter who is in power, Dhoot manages to get his point across.

LITTLE KNOWN FACT: Started his entrepreneurial life as a dealer for Bajaj Auto.

TIME OFF: Often spends the morning playing the flute.

KEEP FIT MANTRA: Yoga and meditation.

BIG ACQUISITION: Has just bought an 11-seater Challenger 605, which can reach London with a single pitstop.

ROAD AHEAD: Setting up SEZs across 35 million sq ft in seven cities.



BANDEEP SINGH

40

PARMESHWAR GODREJ

62, SOCIAL ARBITER (40)

WILL & GRACE

BECAUSE she's the original Queen G, society queen, social arbiter and style icon at large. Because international celebrity buddies like Richard Gere, Imran Khan and Salman Rushdie have not only found a gracious host in her but also a safe refuge at her Juhu homestead. Because her AIDS awareness activities continue and now she has managed to rope in Rushdie for her high-profile campaign, much to the consternation of the All India Ulema Association. Because she sits on the board of several influential charities, from the Bill Gates Foundation to the American India Foundation, which has Bill Clinton as honorary chairman. Because she defies every stereotype of the idle rich.

THE ROAD AHEAD: She wants to build her real estate business, Godrej Properties, into a "world class avant garde company with a cutting edge, which changes the way in which our contemporaries think and practice".

THE BIG ACQUISITION: Her beautiful daughter-in-law, Karla, who married son Phirojsha last year.

THE BIG DISCOVERY: That her five-year-old grandson prefers to watch the US Primaries with her instead of *Tom & Jerry*.

